

always worth exploring when we're looking for answers about how to move forward. When we choose a partner, we so rarely consider financial compatibility – and it's easy to see why, as it's not exactly the sexiest or most romantic topic in the world – but who we share our lives with has a huge impact on our relationship with money.

Charlotte* explains how she started off with a positive relationship with money, working to earn it from a young age and planning for her future. 'Growing up, from the age of fourteen, I worked for my money – school holidays, weekends, evenings . . . you name it, I worked it. I don't remember saving any of this money in my teenage years, but I do remember that any money I was gifted for Christmas or birthdays, half of it went into my bank account, which contributed to my ability to buy a car at eighteen. I left university after three months, deciding it wasn't for me, and began working full time. This is when I started to save regularly, through a financial adviser, into a stocks and shares ISA and a pension.'

Charlotte's money habits changed, though, when she met her ex-partner. 'We used all of my savings as a deposit to buy a house together, when I was twenty-one,' she says. 'He was a builder and worked for cash in hand, while my salary went into the bank to cover the bills. Except we didn't have individual accounts, we just had one account between us for bills and living expenses, and he had access to my salary, but I never had access to his cash. He would regularly drain the account, took out an overdraft to cover the bills, and basically taught